

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Employment patterns, salary benchmarks by role and language, workplace preferences, and purchasing influence for engineering managers and HR leaders.

65,437

Survey respondents

Global developer sample

180+

Countries represented

International coverage

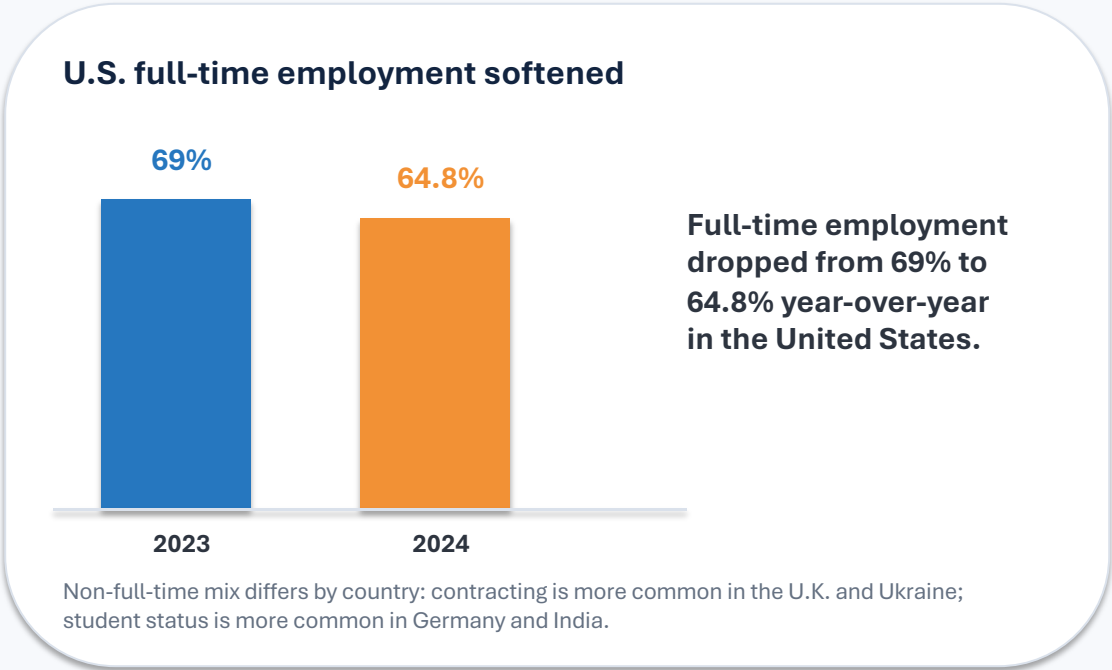
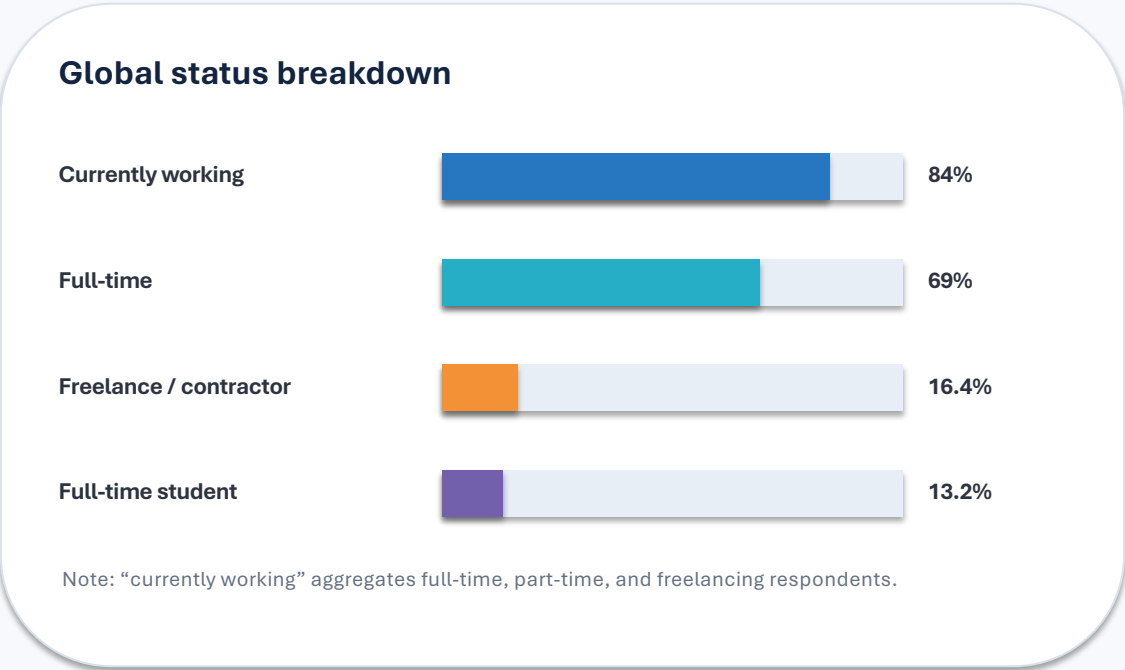
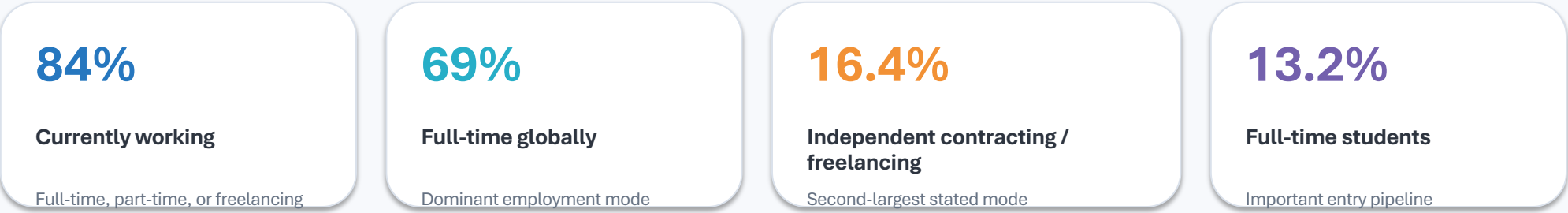
22,677

Salary responses

34.7% response rate

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

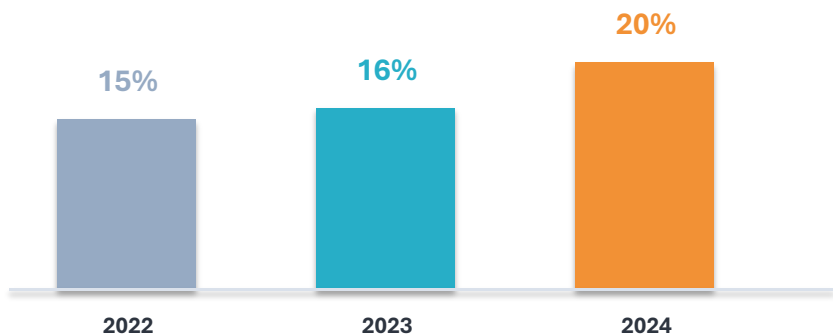
Employment status signals from 65,437 respondents



In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

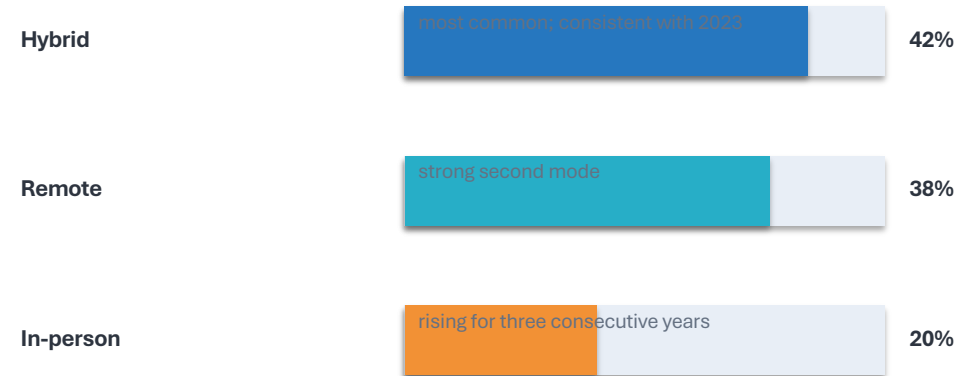
Work environment trends point to gradual return-to-office pressure

In-person work: third consecutive rise



+5 percentage points since 2022

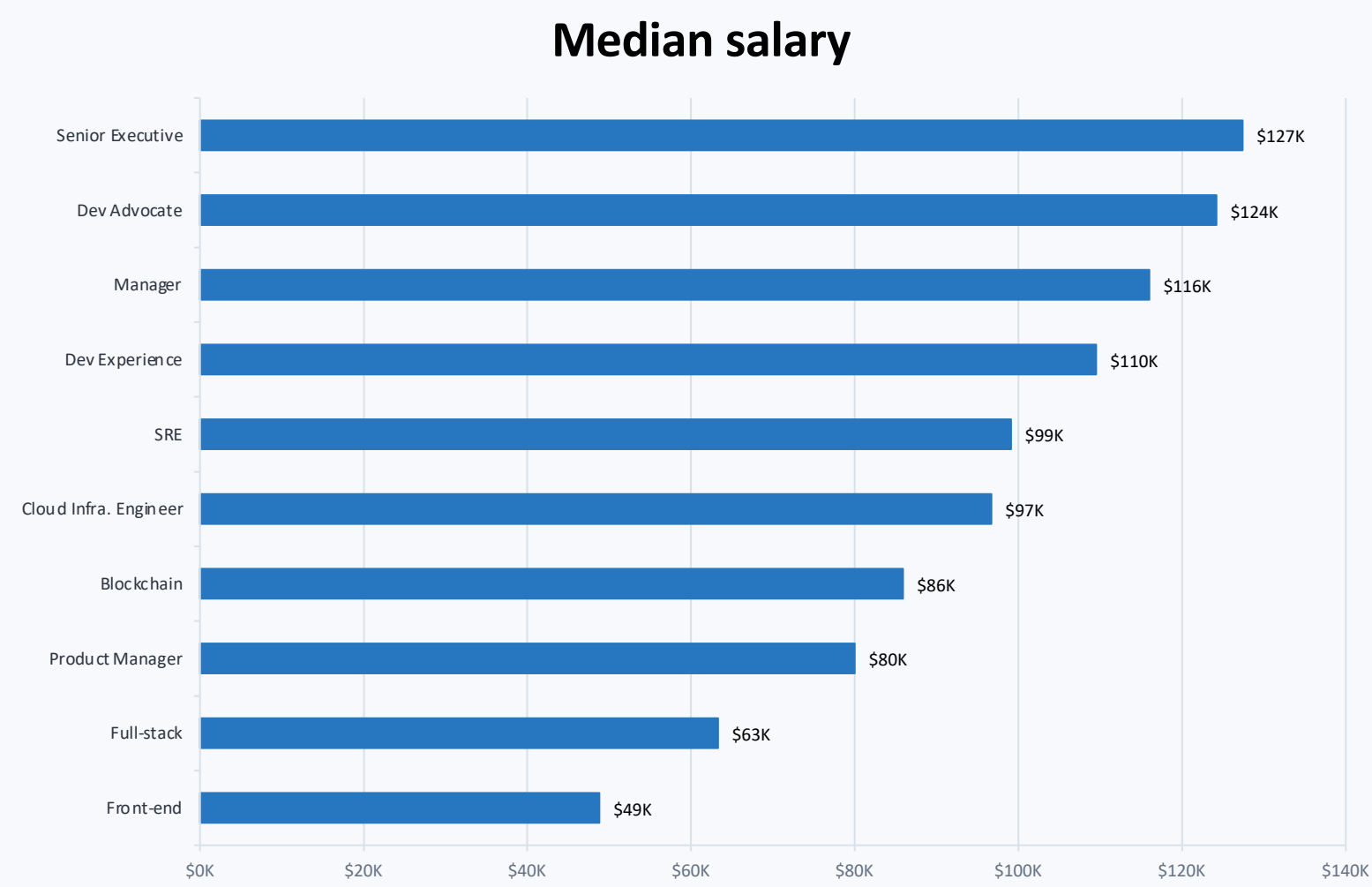
2024 work environment mix



Implication for leaders: hybrid remains the default benchmark, while in-office expectations are increasingly part of retention risk and offer negotiation.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Median annual compensation by developer type, USD; 22,677 salary responses



Benchmark readout

1. Senior Executive

\$127K median • ~17 yrs exp.

2. Dev Advocate

\$124K median • ~16 yrs exp.

3. Manager

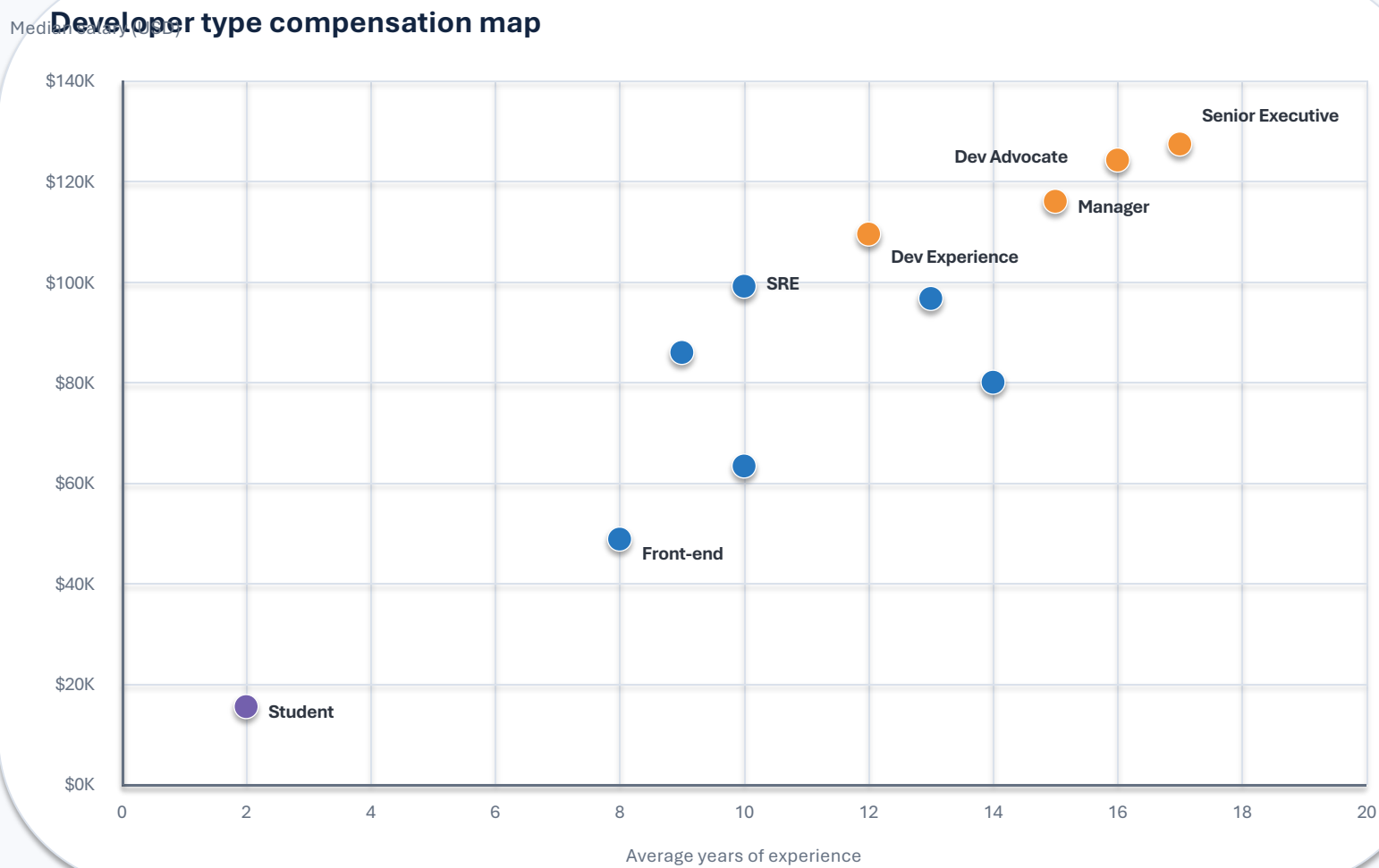
\$116K median • ~15 yrs exp.

Pure technical premium: SRE (\$99K) and Cloud Infrastructure Engineer (\$97K) are the highest-paid non-leadership technical roles in the listed benchmark set.

Chart values drawn from source table associated with figure_1.jpg.

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Median salary versus average years of experience by developer type



What to benchmark

Upper-right cluster

Senior Executive, Dev Advocate, and Manager roles pair ~\$116K–\$127K median pay with ~15–17 years of average experience.

Technical premium

SRE (\$99K, ~10 yrs) and Cloud Infrastructure Engineer (\$97K, ~13 yrs) are high-value retention targets.

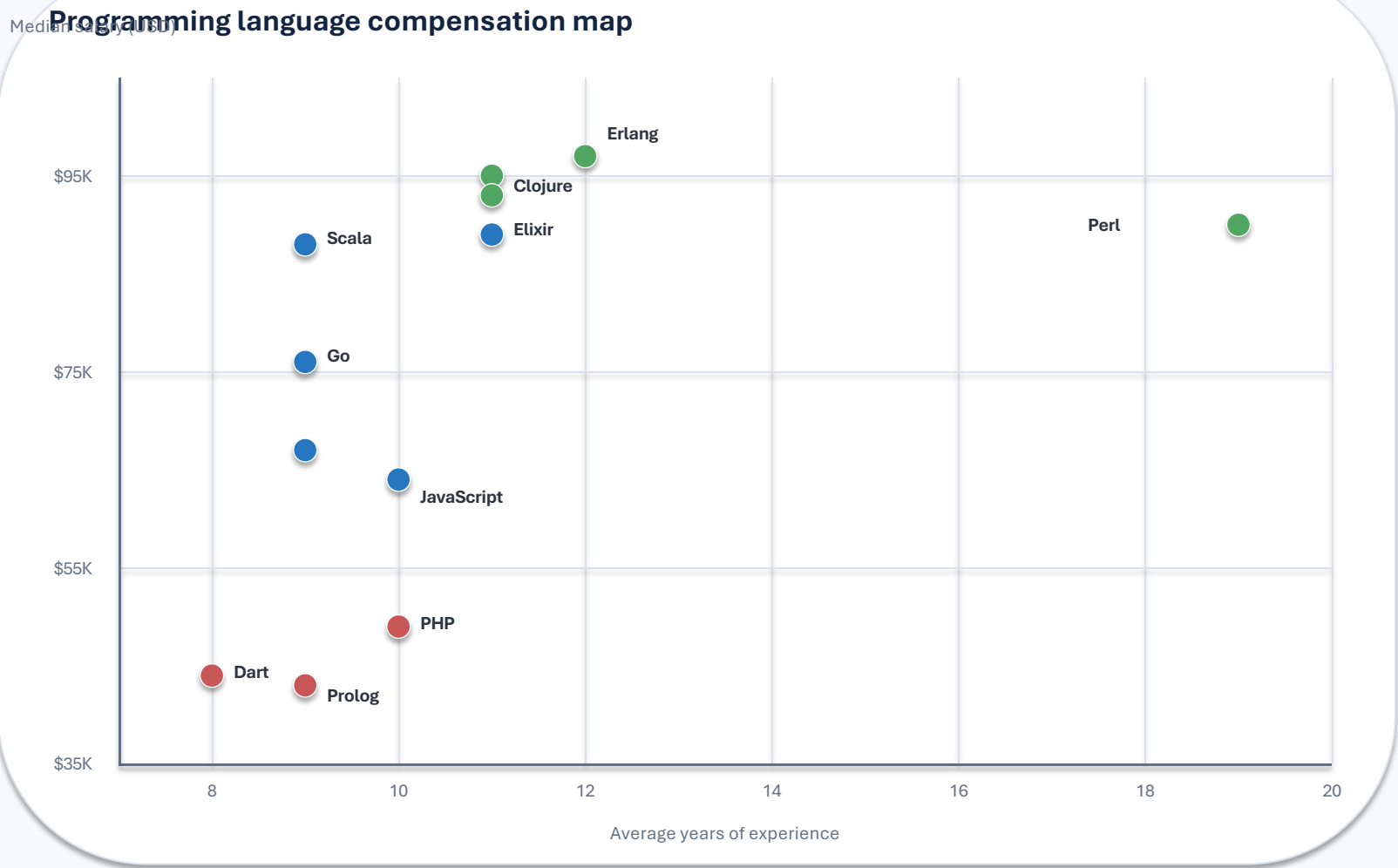
Entry outlier

Student benchmark sits at \$15K with ~2 years of average experience.

Scatter values drawn from source table associated with figure_2.jpg. Response counts by role were not provided in the brief.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary versus average experience by programming language



Language signals

Top median salaries

Erlang: ~\$97K • ~12 yrs

Clojure: ~\$95K • ~11 yrs

Elixir: ~\$93K • ~11 yrs

Lowest listed salaries

Dart: ~\$44K • ~8 yrs

Prolog: ~\$43K • ~9 yrs

PHP: ~\$49K • ~10 yrs

Overall range shift

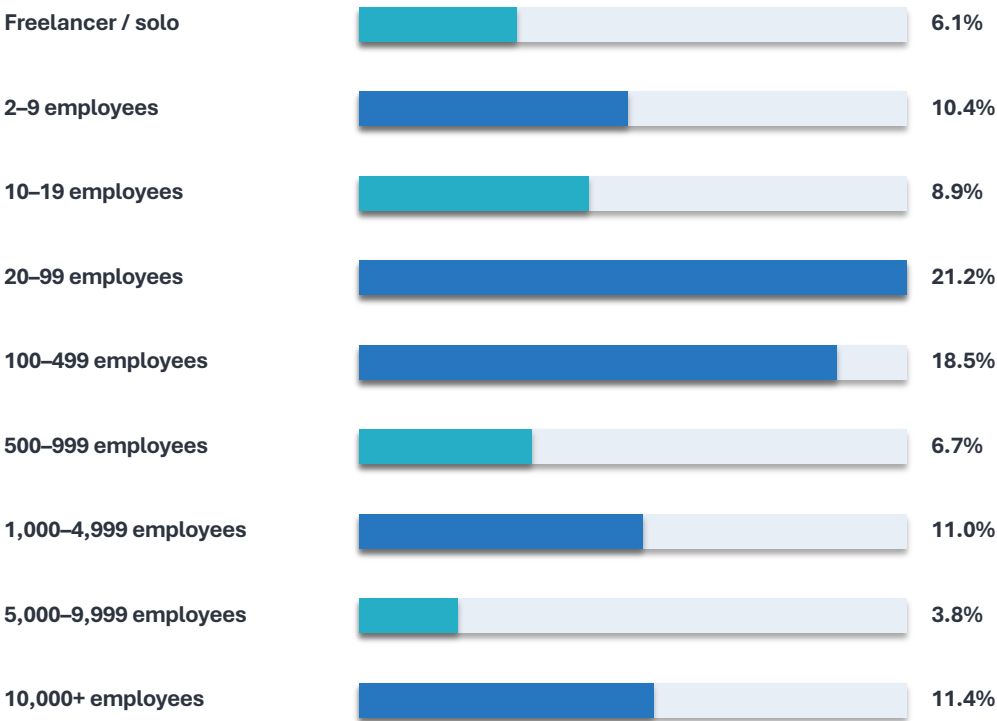
Reported salary range dropped roughly \$10K versus 2023, averaging \$60–75K in 2024 versus \$70–85K last year.

Scatter values drawn from source table associated with figure_3.jpg.

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

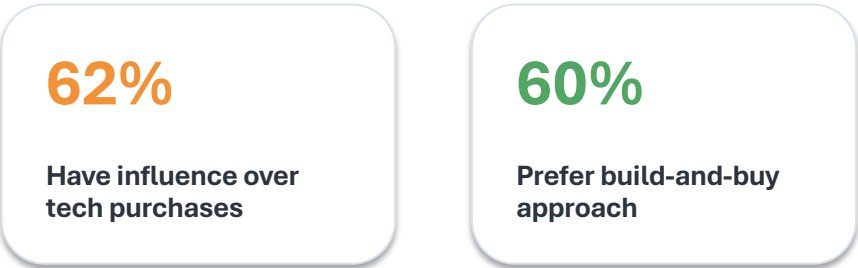
Company-size context and technology-buying influence

Company-size distribution



47% of respondents work for organizations with fewer than 100 employees; company-size distribution reflects 42,827 respondents.

Purchasing influence



Most influential roles



Evaluation behavior: starting a free trial (75%) and asking other developers (73%) are the top methods for assessing new tools.

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Actionable implications for engineering managers and HR leaders

1

Plan for mixed workforce models

Full-time employment remains dominant globally at 69%, but U.S. full-time employment fell from 69% to 64.8%; keep contractor and freelance capacity in workforce plans.

2

Treat hybrid as the market baseline

Hybrid is still the most common arrangement at 42%, while in-person work reached 20% after three consecutive annual increases.

3

Budget premiums for scarce roles

Dev Advocates (\$124K), SREs (\$99K), and Cloud Infrastructure Engineers (\$97K) require targeted compensation and retention strategies.

4

Use language mix as a pay-risk signal

Niche functional languages correlate with higher median pay: Erlang (~\$97K), Clojure (~\$95K), and Elixir (~\$93K) lead the listed language benchmarks.

5

Engage developers in tool decisions

62% influence technology purchases; free trials (75%) and developer peer input (73%) are central to evaluation behavior.

Use these benchmarks as directional inputs alongside geography, seniority mix, company size, and role scope before resetting compensation bands.